

MD. SOHEL RANA

Merchandising Team Leader | Apparel Sourcing, Costing & Vendor Management for European Fashion Brands

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Merchandising and sourcing leader with 14+ years in Bangladesh RMG, from factory floor to European liaison offices. Currently lead a four-person team at LPP S.A. managing roughly 3 million pieces a year across 35 vendors — costing, negotiation, allocation, and production execution for five brands, with 97% on-time delivery in the latest season. Earlier drove 1.5 million pieces a year for Celio and co-built New Wave Group's trading arm to USD 35 million in annual order value. I write RMG Xpress Insights, a weekly LinkedIn newsletter on where apparel sourcing is heading: sustainability, EU compliance (CSDDD, EUDR), and AI in the supply chain.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Merchandising & Sourcing: Strategic sourcing · Vendor allocation & sharing · Supplier development & onboarding · Capacity planning & booking

Commercial: FOB costing & pre-cost analysis · Price negotiation · Margin management · Claim handling · Market & raw-material price analysis

Execution: Critical path / TNA management · Production monitoring · On-time delivery · Quality compliance · Order management (inquiry to shipment)

Leadership & Tools: Team leadership · Buying-meeting coordination · Cross-border collaboration (Poland HQ) · Advanced Excel, Power BI · AI tools (ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini) for reporting & analysis

Industry Direction: Sustainable sourcing (OCS, recycled, OEKO-TEX STeP) · EU due-diligence awareness (CSDDD, EUDR)

Product Range: Denim & Non-denim · Circular & Flat Knit · Woven · Accessories (PU, Leather, Nylon/Woven)

CAREER HIGHLIGHTS

- Delivered 97% on-time shipment in the latest season at LPP while managing ~3 million pieces/year across 35 vendors — and grew Dhaka office order volume 10% season-on-season against LPP's Bangladesh growth target.
- Lead merchandising for five European brands (Sinsay, Reserved, Cropp, House, Mohito) — denim for three brands, accessories for all five — heading a team of 4.
- Ran 1.5 million pieces/year at Celio (including 1M polos and 0.3M underwear/nightwear), 70+ styles per season across 14 factories, hitting 94% on-time delivery.
- Helped push 30% of Celio's collection into sustainable production (organic OCS, recycled) and drove the vendor OEKO-TEX STeP certification program toward the MADE IN GREEN label.
- Co-built New Wave Group's trading business (Multi Sourcing Asia Ltd.) from a two-merchandiser start to USD 35 million in annual order value, opening 15 buyer accounts including Björn Borg, SEBAGO, Volvo AB, and Aditya Birla Fashion & Retail.
- Publish a weekly LinkedIn newsletter (RMG Xpress Insights) plus daily posts on Bangladesh RMG, sourcing, compliance, and AI.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Merchandising Team Leader

Feb 2024 – Present

LPP S.A. Bangladesh Liaison Office · Dhaka, Bangladesh

Scope: Lead a 4-person merchandising team handling ~3M pieces/year across 35 active vendors — denim for Cropp, House, and Mohito; non-textile accessories for all five LPP brands including Sinsay and Reserved.

- Achieved 97% on-time delivery in the latest season by tightening capacity monitoring and weekly vendor follow-ups across 35 suppliers.
- Hit LPP's growth target for Bangladesh: grew the Dhaka Liaison Office's supplier order volume 10% season-on-season.
- Manage end-to-end order execution for ~3 million pieces a year — from pre-cost evaluation and FOB negotiation through allocation, production, and shipment.
- Sourced and onboarded 8 new vendors in 2025–26 and introduced vendor-sharing and allocation strategies that balanced capacity across brands.
- Negotiate pricing and lead times against brand target margins; run pre-cost analyses with suppliers before every buying meeting.
- Work directly with Polish counterparts on seasonal development, market trends, and sourcing strategy; coach and review a team of four merchandisers covering denim, woven bottoms, and accessories.

Account Lead Merchandiser

Dec 2018 – Feb 2024

Celio Sourcing Limited, Bangladesh Liaison Office · Dhaka, Bangladesh

Scope: Independently ran the tee, polo, sweatshirt, nightwear, pyjama, and accessory accounts — ~1.5M pieces/year (including 1M fine-knit polos and 0.3M underwear/nightwear), 70+ styles per season, 14 factories, six buying seasons a year.

- Hit 94% on-time delivery on 70+ styles by holding suppliers to the T&A from lab dip through final inspection.
- Negotiated against target margins across six seasonal buying meetings a year, tracking yarn and fabric prices to build the cost data behind every negotiation.
- Helped lift sustainable production to 30% of the collection (organic OCS, recycled) and pushed vendor OEKO-TEX STeP certification toward an 80% coverage target for the MADE IN GREEN label.
- Executed licensed-product programs across entertainment, anime, gaming, and sports IPs — Marvel, Warner Bros. (Batman, Superman, Harry Potter, Rick & Morty), Cartoon Network, Star Wars, Naruto, Dragon Ball, One Piece, Pokémon, and NBA — handling artwork approvals and licensor compliance alongside core lines.
- Developed and onboarded new suppliers for core programs while keeping qualified backup sources for risk cover.
- Handled claims, vendor ratings, and supplier-strategy data; trained vendors on new systems and ran performance evaluations for management review.

Key Lead Merchandiser (Senior Role)

Dec 2014 – Nov 2018

New Wave Group, Bangladesh Liaison Office · Dhaka, Bangladesh

Scope: First year on New Wave's own brands (Craft, Cottover); then co-built the group's trading business through its intercompany Multi Sourcing Asia Ltd. — circular knit, flat knit, and woven for European corporate and sportswear buyers.

- Started the Multi Sourcing Asia trading operation as one of its first two merchandisers and grew it to USD 35 million in annual order value by the time I left in 2018.
- Opened and developed 15 new buyer accounts: Björn Borg, SEBAGO, Salming Sports AB, Volvo AB, Ralawise, Premier Clothing Ltd., L-SHOP-TEAM GmbH, Aditya Birla Fashion & Retail Ltd., Oy Sultrade Ltd., IDÉ House of Brands Finland, Creon Promotion AB, ACC Another Clothing Concept AB, J:son Handels AB, Sport Design Sweden, and Swedemount Sportswear & Fashion.
- Quoted and negotiated prices both ways — buyers and suppliers — protecting margin while staying competitive.
- Ran accounts end to end: development presentations, T&A plans, approvals (fabric, trims, embellishment, samples), QA files for inline/bulk/final inspection, and LC coordination with the commercial team.

Merchandiser / Assistant Merchandiser

Nov 2011 – Dec 2014

Crystal Martin Apparel Bangladesh Ltd. (Crystal Group, UK) · Valuka, Mymensingh

Scope: Factory-side merchandising for knit and woven programs — the production-floor grounding behind everything since.

- Prepared initial costings for buyer inquiries and built TNA/critical-path plans with IE and planning to protect delivery dates.
- Ran PP meetings, tracked submissions and approvals, and monitored cutting, print/embroidery, washing, and finishing through daily production reports.
- Managed fabric, trims, and accessories inventory through the ERP system and chased physical/chemical test reports to final inspection.

PUBLICATIONS & THOUGHT LEADERSHIP

- RMG Xpress Insights by Soheli — weekly LinkedIn newsletter on Bangladesh RMG: sourcing strategy, costing, EU compliance (CSDDD, EUDR), sustainability, and AI in apparel.
- Daily LinkedIn posts on merchandising practice and industry direction.

EDUCATION & TRAINING

Post Graduate Diploma in Garments Business (PGD-GB) — IBA, University of Dhaka	2025 – ongoing
B.Sc. in Textile Engineering (Wet Processing Technology – Dyeing) — City University, Bangladesh	2011
Industrial Training, Knitting & Dyeing — International Classic Composite Ltd (ICCL), Gazipur	2011

LANGUAGES

Bengali (native) · English (full professional)